

MICHAEL THORPE

Prompt Engineer | LLM Application Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Prompt Engineer with 3+ years designing, optimizing, and shipping LLM-powered applications across OpenAI (GPT-4/4o), Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, and open-source models (LLaMA, Mistral). Proven open-source contributor with 18,000+ GitHub stars across privacy-tech and prompt-engineering projects. I build RAG pipelines, agentic workflows, prompt-evaluation harnesses, and reusable prompt-pattern systems that reduce hallucinations, lower token cost, and turn ambiguous product requirements into reliable AI features.

CORE SKILLS

LLMs & APIs: OpenAI (GPT-4, GPT-4o, o1), Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Meta LLaMA, Mistral, Hugging Face

Prompt Engineering: Chain-of-Thought, ReAct, Tree-of-Thought, Self-Consistency, Few-shot / Zero-shot, System-Prompt Architecture, Prompt Patterns, Structured Output (JSON / Pydantic), Guardrails

RAG & Retrieval: Vector Databases (Pinecone, Weaviate, Chroma, FAISS), Embeddings (OpenAI, Cohere, Sentence-Transformers), Hybrid Search, Reranking, Chunking Strategies

Frameworks: LangChain, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, DSPy, Semantic Kernel, Guidance

Agentic AI: Function Calling, Tool Use, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Model Context Protocol (MCP), AutoGen

Evaluation: LangSmith, Ragas, TruLens, Promptfoo, A/B Testing, LLM-as-Judge, Regression Suites

Fine-Tuning: LoRA, QLoRA, RLHF fundamentals, Dataset Curation, Hugging Face Transformers

Languages & Tools: Python, JavaScript, FastAPI, Git, Docker, Linux, REST APIs, Markdown, YAML

Soft Skills: Technical writing, prompt documentation, stakeholder communication, cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Prompt Engineer – Vertex AI Solutions

Remote / Jacksonville, FL | 2024 - Present

- Designed and shipped 30+ production prompts for customer-facing GPT-4 and Claude features, lifting task success rate by 38% and trimming token cost 25% through prompt compression and few-shot tuning.
- Built a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline with LangChain, Pinecone, and OpenAI embeddings over 50K+ internal documents, reaching 91% retrieval@5 and cutting hallucinations 60% versus baseline.
- Implemented an evaluation harness with LangSmith and Promptfoo that automates regression testing across 200+ prompt variants, catching quality drift before release.
- Authored an internal prompt-pattern playbook (chain-of-thought, role-prompting, structured output, guardrails) later adopted by 4 cross-functional teams.

AI / Prompt Engineer – NovaTech AI

Remote | 2023 - 2024

- Developed a multi-agent workflow with LangGraph and OpenAI function calling to automate research summarization, shrinking analyst turnaround from 6 hours to 25 minutes.
- Tuned system prompts and JSON output schemas to reach 99.2% structured-output validity, eliminating downstream parsing errors.
- Curated a 12K-example dataset and ran LoRA fine-tunes on Llama-2 13B; deployed the result via Hugging Face Inference Endpoints.
- Partnered closely with PMs and designers to translate fuzzy product asks into measurable prompt specs and clear acceptance criteria.

Junior AI / NLP Engineer – Echo Dynamics

Remote | 2022 - 2023

- Migrated a rules-based chatbot to GPT-3.5 / GPT-4, raising CSAT from 3.6 to 4.5 / 5 across 12K monthly conversations.
- Wrote 100+ reusable prompt templates and evaluation scripts. Established a Git-based prompt-versioning workflow that the team standardized on.
- Benchmarked 8 open-source models (Mistral, LLaMA-2, Falcon) for cost / quality trade-offs and authored the internal model-selection guide.

OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

Betterfox - Creator & Maintainer

github.com/yokoffing/Betterfox

- Authored a Firefox user.js configuration adopted by a 10,400+ star community (251 forks); maintained continuous releases that track upstream Firefox changes.
- Documented every preference with its rationale - disciplined technical writing and configuration-management skills that transfer directly to system-prompt engineering and prompt versioning.

ChatGPT-Prompts - Curator

github.com/yokoffing/ChatGPT-Prompts

- Curated a public library of high-performing ChatGPT and Bing AI prompts (897 stars, 82 forks) spanning reasoning, writing, coding, and analysis use cases.
- Established a prompt-engineering taxonomy (persona, output format, constraints, examples) now used by community contributors.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science

University of North Florida, Jacksonville, FL | 2022